DIAGEO INDIA A COMMITTED PARTNER TO VIKSIT BHARAT



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The Viksit Bharat agenda envisions India as a developed nation by 2047, emphasizing inclusive growth, technological innovation, and infrastructure development to uplift all sections of society. Corporates play a pivotal role by driving economic growth, fostering innovation, creating jobs, and aligning their CSR initiatives with national priorities like skill development, sustainability, and digital transformation. Hina Nagarajan, Managing Director and CEO, Diageo India, talks about some of their key initiatives in this direction.

How is Diageo India supporting India's Viksit Bharat vision?

Diageo India, among the leading alcobev players, has supported India's economic progress through a substantial investment of USD 3.5 billion since 2014. In addition, last year alone, we contributed approximately INR 20,500 crore/USD 2.45 billion to state and federal exchequers.

Our commitment to Viksit Bharat is evident through our initiatives across the value chain, be it working with farmers to transform agricultural practices, to boosting employment and skills development, and driving innovation in the alcobev category.

Our portfolio of premium Indian brands, such as McDowell's, Black Dog, Indian single malt Godawan and Antiquity, are exported to over 35 countries and showcase Indian craftsmanship to the world. Our 36 manufacturing facilities across India provide us with a large manufacturing footprint and distillation capacity in the country. We have helped create over 1,00,000 jobs, while supporting an additional 3,75,000 jobs in affiliate sectors.

How is Diageo contributing to the Make in India initiative?

We have an outstanding portfolio of global brands and local jewels. Our Made in India McDowells No 1 is the largest selling whisky globally, and Godawan, our artisanal single malt is the most awarded Indian single malt globally. Each bottle tells a story of conscious creation, preserving India's cultural heritage under our ethos of being 'crafted for good.' Distilled in Alwar, Rajasthan, Godawan uses locally sourced six-row barley and is committed to sustainability. The brand actively supports the conservation of the Great Indian Bustard, which is an endangered species.

We have invested INR 200 crore/$23.85mn in driving innovations and R&D, building world-class products and developing sustainable packaging solutions. over the last 5 years. In 2022, we launched The Good Craft Co (our innovation hub) in Goa which brings to life Diageo's innovation first and builder's philosophy. In addition, we launched our first experimental lab, The Good Craft Co. Flavour Lab in Bangalore. This consumer experience centre doubles up as an innovation hotbed for young industry talent.

What steps has Diageo India taken to foster sustainability?

At Diageo, ESG is a critical pillar of our business strategy, aligning our efforts with India's vision for a sustainable future and the UN Sustainable Development Goals. 'Spirit of Progress', our ESG action plan, is helping us realize our net-zero roadmap. We're pioneering grain-to-glass sustainability, from sourcing raw materials responsibly to minimizing our environmental footprint. We've taken significant steps, such as eliminating coal from our distilleries and increasing the use of renewable energy.

We have reduced our greenhouse gas emissions by 87% and transitioned to 98.6% renewable energy in direct operations since 2020. Additionally, we've prioritized responsible water usage and waste reduction and have improved water use efficiency in distillation by 48% and packaging by 31% from base year 2020. We have also replenished over 1 million cubic meters of water, exceeding our targets by 25%, three years ahead of our goals.

I am particularly proud of The Godavari Initiative that we spearheaded this year. We are taking a pioneering approach to water stewardship for the Godavari River that will positively impact neighbouring communities.

